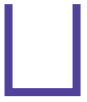
Keep the notes. Change the signs.

The same written shape can name different notes in the vocal and instrumental alphabets. Work with selected Lydian diatonic pairs, then read the Greek descriptions beside their complete printed pages.

> Selected diatonic Lydian sign pairs and four shared Lydian/Hypolydian pairs from Alypius, Jan 1895 pp368–370. Modern vector teaching signs, a newly composed practice line, chosen tuning and reference constraints, equal durations and synthetic sine tones. These are not a manuscript facsimile, a complete Greek notation decoder or a recovered ancient performance.

Across the two alphabets

This short line is newly composed for the lesson. It is not an ancient melody. The saved working line, including blanks or mistaken signs, is retained below.

Given vocal	Row 8	 Row 12	 Row 11	Row 8
Written instrumental	 sideways lambda	 zeta	 open-topped square sign	 sideways lambda

2 of 4 notes preserve the given pitch in this model; 0 slots are blank. A matching shape alone does not establish a matching note. Inspect the selected slot and the printed pair.

Actual saved choices, without silently resolving ambiguous functions

Slot	Given function	Written sign reads	Pitch in chosen model
1	mesē	mesē	preserved
2	paramesē	nētē synēmmenōn or diezeugmenōn diatonos	294.134997 cents difference
3	nētē synēmmenōn	tritē diezeugmenōn	-203.910002 cents difference
4	mesē	mesē	preserved

pyknon-notation.json pyknon-notation.csv pyknon-notation.svg pyknon-notation-tables.csv pyknon-notation-tables.svg pyknon-notation-sources.json pyknon-notation.wav Reopen this translation

The sound is an explicit model

The given line plays first, followed by the actual written line. Unwritten slots stay silent; the timing is not compressed to hide them.

pythagorean instructional tuning, with Lydian mesē set to 330 Hz. Pythagorean rows use the disclosed rational intervals; equal-tempered rows use 2^(semitones/12). Both are modern realizations of this lesson. The table does not record a concert-pitch standard, exact note durations or an instrument timbre.

Finite sine tones, 48,000 samples/s, mono 16-bit PCM. Schedule: 0 s: 330 Hz for 0.6 s; 0.75 s: 371.25 Hz for 0.6 s; 1.5 s: 440 Hz for 0.6 s; 2.25 s: 330 Hz for 0.6 s; 3.6 s: 330 Hz for 0.6 s; 4.35 s: 440 Hz for 0.6 s; 5.1 s: 391.111111 Hz for 0.6 s; 5.85 s: 330 Hz for 0.6 s. The two alphabets are compared sequentially, not as a claimed ancient two-part performance.

Selected Lydian diatonic rows · Jan 1895 p369. First sign vocal, second instrumental.

Printed row / function	Vocal	Instrumental	Modern model
5 ὑπάτη μέσων hypatē mesōn			247.5 Hz
6 παρυπάτη μέσων parypatē mesōn			260.740741 Hz
7 μέσων διάτονος mesōn diatonos			293.333333 Hz
8 μέση mesē			330 Hz
11 νήτη συνημμένων nētē synēmmenōn			440 Hz
12 παραμέση paramesē			371.25 Hz
13 τρίτη διεζευγμένων tritē diezeugmenōn			391.111111 Hz
14 διεζευγμένων διάτονος diezeugmenōn diatonos			440 Hz
15 νήτη διεζευγμένων nētē diezeugmenōn			495 Hz

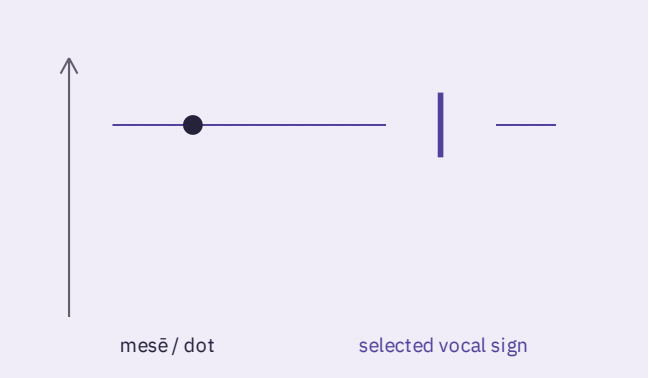
One pair, two tables

The selected pair is compared under a chosen modern reference constraint. Lydian mesē remains at 330 Hz. Either the shared sign stays at its Lydian pitch or both mesai stay at that reference.

Lydian

μέση

mesē · printed row 8, p369

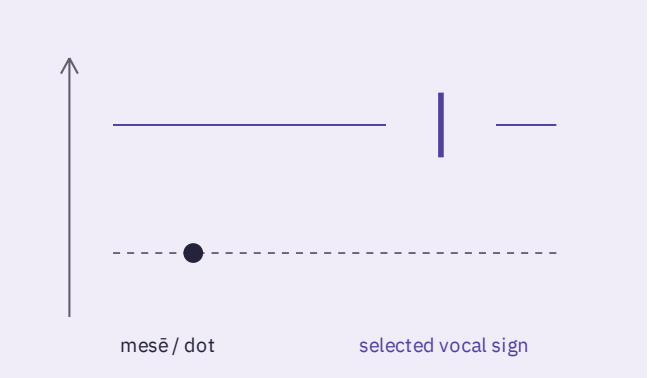


Mesē in this context	330 Hz
Selected sign	330 Hz · 1/1 × this mesē

Hypolydian

νήτη συνημμένων / διεζευγμένων διάτονος

nētē synēmmenōn or diezeugmenōn diatonos · printed rows 11 / 14, p370



Mesē in this context	247.5 Hz
Selected sign	330 Hz · 4/3 × this mesē

The selected sign keeps its Lydian modeled pitch. The Hypolydian mesē moves. Hypolydian/Lydian mesē ratio: 3/4; selected-sign ratio: 1/1. Lydian mesē 330 Hz; Hypolydian mesē 247.5 Hz. These ratios and hertz values belong to the chosen modern model.

The dot and selected sign use one common current logarithmic pitch scale. The source gives the paired functional names; the rational and equal-step realizations are modern models. Two possible functions stay visible where their pair agrees.

Read the descriptions

New selected transcription from Karl von Jan's 1895 edition. Greek theta letterforms, line breaks and end-of-line hyphens are normalized; middle dots separate selected entries where stated. Square brackets and variant letter-name spellings remain visible. New English and contextual grammar have not received independent philological review. The complete pages retain Jan's apparatus and his modern staff transcriptions.

Two alphabets above one table

[λυδίου τρόπου σημεῖα. τὰ μὲν ἄνω τῆς λέξεως. τὰ δὲ κάτω τῆς κρούσεως.]

[Signs of the Lydian tonos. The upper ones are for words; the lower ones for instrumental playing.]

The conventional labels here are ‘vocal’ and ‘instrumental’. λέξις concerns verbal delivery; κροῦσις concerns striking or instrumental playing. This is a key to two notations, not an instruction to play the upper and lower rows as two simultaneous parts. Jan prints the whole heading in square brackets and proposes moving it after p368 line 18. Those brackets and his note remain in the scan.

σημεῖα

signs; marks. Neuter plural of σημεῖον. The shape on the page is a sign; its alphabet and table determine the reading.

τὰ μὲν ἄνω … τὰ δὲ κάτω

the upper ones … the lower ones. The μέν … δέ pair organizes a contrast. On p368 the two notation rows are literally above and below each other; on p369 each prose entry writes the two signs side by side.

Inspect the whole printed page.

Fixed is not a measured number of hertz

ἑστῶτες μὲν οὖν λέγονται, ὅτι ἐν ταῖς τῶν γενῶν διαφοραῖς οὐ μεταπίπτουσιν. κινούμενοι δέ, ὅτι ἐν ταῖς τῶν γενῶν διαφοραῖς μεταπίπτουσιν εἰς ἑτέρας τάσεις.

They are called fixed because, in changes of genus, they do not shift; movable because, in changes of genus, they shift to other pitch levels.

The distinction concerns changes of genus, not a recovered concert-pitch standard. The desk uses only selected diatonic rows. Its 330 Hz mesē and two tuning models are explicit modern choices. A sign shape alone is not a universal frequency measurement.

ἑστῶτες

standing; fixed. A masculine plural participle of ἵστημι, agreeing with the notes. Its contrast with κινούμενοι makes a technical category out of a physical verb.

κινούμενοι

moving; movable. Present middle/passive participle of κινέω. The next clause states the relevant movement: a shift in pitch when the genus changes.

Inspect the whole printed page.

Iota becomes a sideways lambda

μέση ἰῶτα καὶ λάβδα πλάγιον

Mesē: iota and sideways lambda.

The vocal sign comes first, the instrumental sign second. The sentence has no written ‘is’: its compact list gives the note name, then a pair of shape descriptions. Keep the note when translating; copying the shape would change or lose the reading. λάβδα is the spelling printed here, rather than silently changing it to λάμβδα.

μέση

middle. Feminine singular, the conventional name of the middle note. It is not automatically the modern tonic, nor the halfway point between every pair of pitches.

πλάγιον

sideways; oblique. Neuter singular, agreeing with the letter name. Compare the sideways lambda at mesē with the sideways pi at paramesē. The diagrams follow the printed results; the adjective does not specify a universal numeric rotation rule.

Inspect the whole printed page.

Sigma can agree, then turn

ὑπάτη μέσων σίγμα καὶ σίγμα · παρυπάτη μέσων ῥῶ καὶ σίγμα ἀνεστραμμένον

Hypatē of the middle tetrachord: sigma and sigma. Parhypatē of the middle tetrachord: rho and upturned sigma.

Two adjacent entries are joined here with a middle dot; the printed line breaks are not retained. The first is a same-shape, same-note control. The next changes the vocal sign to rho and the instrumental sign to an upturned form. Our regular strokes are teaching drawings; they do not reproduce a particular ancient hand.

μέσων

of the middle ones. Genitive plural. In these note names it locates the middle tetrachord; it is not the singular note μέση.

ἀνεστραμμένον

turned up; inverted. Perfect middle/passive participle from ἀναστρέφω, neuter to match the letter name. Identify the printed resulting shape rather than applying one modern 180-degree rule to every ancient use of ‘inverted’.

Inspect the whole printed page.

The pair does not uniquely name the function

νήτη συνημμένων ᾧ τετράγωνον ὕπτιον καὶ ζῆτα · διεζευγμένων διάτονος ᾧ τετράγωνον ὕπτιον καὶ ζῆτα

Nētē of the conjunct tetrachord: square omega lying on its back, and zeta. Diatonic [paranētē] of the disjunct tetrachord: square omega lying on its back, and zeta.

Rows 11 and 14 have the same pair but different functional names. The desk accepts their shared pitch while listing both functions. It does not choose the first name and pretend the ambiguity disappeared. The word paranētē in English is explanatory; it is not printed in that Greek entry.

συνημμένων · διεζευγμένων

of the joined ones · of the separated ones. Genitive plural participles naming conjunct and disjunct tetrachords. The written distinction survives even where the sign pair coincides.

τετράγωνον ὕπτιον

square; lying on its back. Two descriptions of omega’s form. The open-topped square here is a musical sign. Calling it the Latin letter U would hide why the vocal and instrumental descriptions differ.

Inspect the whole printed page.

Change the table, change the function

μέση σίγμα καὶ σίγμα · νήτη συνημμένων ἰῶτα καὶ λάμβδα πλάγιον

Mesē: sigma and sigma. Nētē of the conjunct tetrachord: iota and sideways lambda.

These selected entries now belong to the Hypolydian table. Sigma's Lydian function was hypatē mesōn; iota's was mesē. Compare the two complete pages. 'Lydian' and 'Hypolydian' here name table contexts, not a modern piano mode or evidence for one timeless regional performance style. No cross-table Hz reconstruction is inferred from this comparison.

Ὑπολυδίου

of the Hypolydian. Genitive in the table heading. The prefix ὑπο- changes which named table is being read; it does not tell you how a modern Lydian scale should be played.

λάμβδα

lambda. This page prints λάμβδα where the preceding Lydian entry prints λάβδα. The readings retain that small difference rather than presenting a silently uniform ancient text.

Inspect the whole printed page.

The retained sign sheet

PYKNON / ALYPIUS, JAN 1895 pp368–369 / NEW TEACHING DIAGRAMS

Keep the notes. Change the signs.

Across the two alphabets · newly composed exercise · vocal to instrumental



pythagorean instructional tuning; Lydian mese = 330 Hz; finite displayed approximations.

The paired lookup / selected functions, not a universal shape-to-frequency code

	Vocal	Instrumental	Model ratio to mese
5. hypatē mesōn			3/4
6. parypatē mesōn			64/81
7. mesōn diatonos			8/9
8. mesē			1/1
11. nētē synēmmenōn			4/3
12. paramesē			9/8
13. tritē diezeugmenōn			32/27
14. diezeugmenōn diatonos			4/3
15. nētē diezeugmenōn			3/2

Rows 11 and 14 retain different function names despite sharing both signs and the modeled pitch.

Original strokes are regularized; inspect the retained whole pages for their printed forms and apparatus.

No ancient concert pitch, instrument timbre, absolute duration or performance is recovered.

New code, English and diagrams: MIT, Anton Soloviev 2026. Plex: SIL OFL 1.1. Full notices in metadata.

The whole printed evidence

Karl von Jan, Musici scriptores graeci, Teubner, Leipzig, 1895; Alypius, Eisagoge mousike, pp367–370. Poppler pdftoppm; complete pages, longest side 2200 px, JPEG quality 88; no cropping, recolouring or reconstruction.

MUSICI SCRIPTORES GRAECI.

ARISTOTELES EUCLIDES NICOMACHUS
BACCHIUS GAUDENTIUS ALYPIUS

ET MELODIARUM VETERUM QUIDQUID EXSTAT.

RECOGNOVIT PROOEMIIS ET INDICE INSTRUXIT

Karl von Jan

CAROLUS JANUS
LUD. FIL.

ANNEXAE SUNT TABULAE.

LIPSIAE
IN AEDIBUS B. G. TEUBNERI.
MDCCCXCV.

Title · PDF p7 · Title, editor and MDCCCXCV (1895).

ΑΛΥΠΙΟΥ
ΕΙΣΑΓΩΓΗ ΜΟΥΣΙΚΗ.

Τῆς μουσικῆς ἐκ τριῶν τῶν συνεκτικωτάτων ἐπι-
στημῶν τελειουμένης, ἁρμονικῆς ῥυθμικῆς μετρικῆς,
πρώτην τε τάξει καὶ στοιχειωδεστάτην νοητέον τὴν
περὶ τὸ ἡρμοσμένον πραγματείαν. αὕτη δὲ ἁρμονικὴ
καλεῖται [δια]κριτικήν τινα δύναμιν ἔχουσα καὶ κατα-
ληπτικὴν τῶν ἐμμελῶν καὶ διαστηματικῶν φθόγγων
καὶ τῶν ἐν αὐτοῖς γινομένων διαφορῶν.

2. *Ἀναστρέφεται δὲ μάλιστα καὶ θεωρεῖται περὶ*
τὸ ἡρμοσμένον τῆς μουσικῆς μέρος. οὗ μέρη ἑπτά·
πρῶτον περὶ φθόγγων, δεύτερον περὶ διαστημάτων,
τρίτον περὶ συστημάτων, τέταρτον περὶ γενῶν, πέμπτον
περὶ τόνων, ἕκτον περὶ μεταβολῶν, ἕβδομον περὶ αὐτῆς
τῆς μελοποιΐας.

3. *Οὕτω δὲ τεταγμένων τούτων* (p. 2) *εὐχρηστόν*
ἐστιν ἡμῖν ἅμα δὲ καὶ ἀναγκαῖον διδασκαλικώτερον
ἀρχομένοις τῆς ἁρμονικῆς στοιχειώσεως τὴν παράδοσιν
ποιεῖσθαι καὶ πρὸ πάντων αὐτὴν διελεῖν εἰς τοὺς
λεγομένους τρόπους τε καὶ τόνους, ὄντας πεντεκαίδεκα
τὸν ἀριθμόν. ὧν ἐστι πρῶτος ὁ λύδιος. [λυδίου
τρόπου σημεῖα, τὰ μὲν ἄνω τῆς λέξεως, τὰ δὲ κάτω
τῆς κρούσεως.]

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7 *διακριτ.*] scribendum *κριτικήν*. Aristot. supra p. 24—30. Plut. mus. 36. 11 *μέρος* an *μέλος*? 21 *λυδίου κ. τ. λ.* melius transponitur post 368, 18.

Cf. Anon. Bell. II 30. Aristox. princ. harm. § 1. *ἄνω, κάτω* v. ad 350, 10.

4. *Τῶν φθόγγων οἱ μέν εἰσιν ἑστῶτες καὶ ἀκλινεῖς, οἱ δὲ κινούμενοι καὶ κεκλιμένοι. ἑστῶτες μὲν οὖν εἰσιν ὀκτώ· προσλαμβανόμενος, ὑπάτη ὑπάτων, ὑπάτη μέσων, μέση, νήτη συνημμένων, παραμέση, νήτη διεζευγμένων, νήτη ὑπερβολαίων. κινούμενοι δὲ δέκα· δύο παρυπάται, ὑπάτων καὶ μέσων, δύο λιχανοί, ὑπάτων καὶ μέσων· τρεῖς τρίται, συνημμένων διεζευγμένων ὑπερβολαίων· τρεῖς παρανῆται, συνημμένων διεζευγμένων ὑπερβολαίων. ἑστῶτες μὲν οὖν λέγονται, ὅτι ἐν ταῖς τῶν γενῶν διαφοραῖς οὐ μεταπίπτουσιν. κινούμενοι δὲ, ὅτι ἐν ταῖς τῶν γενῶν διαφοραῖς μεταπίπτουσιν εἰς ἑτέρας τάσεις. Τῶν δὲ ἑστώτων φθόγγων οἱ μέν εἰσι βαρύπυκνοι, οἱ δὲ ἄπυκνοι. βαρύπυκνοι μὲν οὖν εἰσι πέντε· ὑπάτη ὑπάτων, ὑπάτη μέσων, μέση, παραμέση, νήτη διεζευγμένων. ἄπυκνοι δὲ τρεῖς· προσλαμβανόμενος, νήτη συνημμένων, νήτη ὑπερβολαίων.* (p. 3)

1. *Λυδίου τρόπου σημεῖα κατὰ τὸ διάτονον γένος.*



1 ἀκλινεῖς] λ M^2. 19 nota 1a in M T. n. 7a et 16a forma minuscula. notae 11a 12b 13a et b 14a 15b abierunt in formas rotundas. nota 15a quasi ϑ fere semper. 15b Ч M. nota 16b V, vide prolegg. 17 et 18 carent accentu.

ἑστῶτες Cleon. c. 4 p. 185.

Printed p368 · PDF p470 · Fixed and movable notes; the complete paired Lydian diatonic table.

Προσλαμβανόμενος ξῆτα ἐλλειπὲς καὶ ταῦ πλάγιον

ὑπάτη ὑπάτων γάμμα ἀπεστραμμένον καὶ γάμμα ὀρθόν

παρυπάτη ὑπάτων βῆτα ἐλλειπὲς καὶ γάμμα ἀνεστραμμένον

ὑπάτων διάτονος φῖ καὶ δίγαμμα

ὑπάτη μέσων σίγμα καὶ σίγμα

παρυπάτη μέσων ῥῶ καὶ σίγμα ἀνεστραμμένον

μέσων διάτονος μῦ καὶ πῖ καθειλκυσμένον

μέση ἰῶτα καὶ λάβδα πλάγιον

τρίτη συνημμένων θῆτα καὶ λάβδα ἀνεστραμμένον

συνημμένων διάτονος γάμμα καὶ νῦ

νήτη συνημμένων ω τετράγωνον ὕπτιον καὶ ξῆτα

παραμέση ξῆτα καὶ πῖ πλάγιον

τρίτη διεζευγμένων ει τετράγωνον καὶ πῖ ἀνεστραμμένον

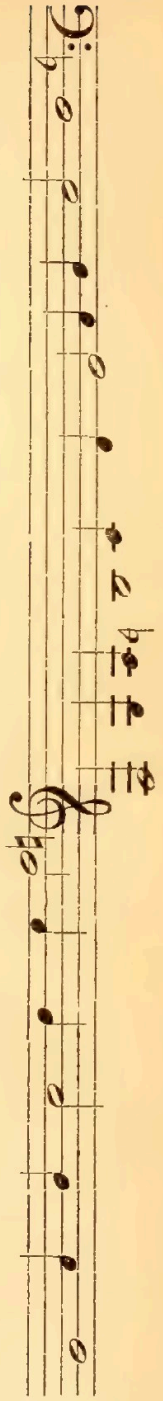
(p.4) *διεζευγμένων διάτονος ω τετράγωνον ὕπτιον καὶ ξῆτα*

νήτη διεζευγμένων φῖ πλάγιον καὶ ἦτα ἀμελητικὸν καθειλκυσμένον

τρίτη ὑπερβολαίων υ κάτω νεῦον καὶ ἡμίαλφα ἀριστερὸν ἄνω νεῦον

ὑπερβολαίων διάτονος μῦ καὶ πῖ καθειλκυσμένον, ἐπὶ τὴν ὀξύτητα

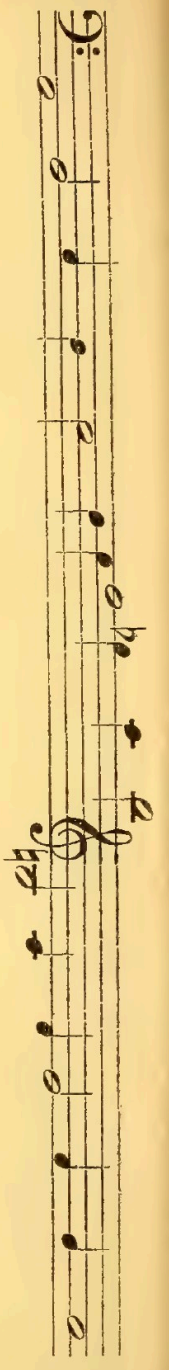
νήτη ὑπερβολαίων ἰῶτα καὶ λάμβδα πλάγιον, ἐπὶ τὴν ὀξύτητα



1 *ἐλλειπές* libri fere semper, saepe M corr. in *ἐλλιπές*. *ἐλλιπὲς* M^1 p. 379, 5. 8. 380, 10. 4. 13. nota 1a erat Z, sed tertia pars erasa. alterum notarum signum, prout spatium suppeditat, aut iuxta alterum positum in M aut infra. cf. ad Bacchium p. 293. 13 *λάβδα*, M^2 insert *μ*. item l. 14. n. 8b ⋌ minusc., cf. Bch. 294, 4. 9b item ϒ. 21 E quadratum M^3, rotundum M^1. n. 16b ϒ v. prolegomena p. 366. n. 17 *μ* min. M.

Printed p369 · PDF p471 · Names, Greek shape descriptions, sign pairs and the editor's modern staff.

2. Ὑπολυδίου σημεῖα κατὰ τὸ διάτονον γένος.



Προσλαμβανόμενος ου κάτω γραμμὴν ἔχον καὶ ἥτα — ϱ H
ὑπάτη ὑπάτων μῦ ἀνεστραμμένον καὶ ἥτα ἐλλειπές — W h
παρυπάτη ὑπάτων λάβδα ἀνεστραμμένον καὶ ἥτα ἐλλειπὲς πλάγιον — V ⊥
ὑπάτων διάτονος ζῆτα ἐλλειπὲς καὶ ταῦ πλάγιον — Ƶ ⊢
ὑπάτη μέσων γάμμα ἀπεστραμμένον καὶ γάμμα ὀρθόν — ⅂ Γ
παρυπάτη μέσων βῆτα ἐλλειπὲς καὶ γάμμα ἀνεστραμμένον — R L
μέσων διάτονος φῖ καὶ δίγαμμα — Φ F
μέση σίγμα καὶ σίγμα (p. 5) — C C
τρίτη συνημμένων ϱῶ καὶ σίγμα ἀνεστρ. — P ↄ
συνημμένων διάτονος μῦ καὶ πῖ καθειλκυσμένον — M ⅂
νήτη συνημμένων ἰῶτα καὶ λάμβδα πλάγιον — I ≺
παράμεσος ου καὶ κάππα — O K
τρίτη διεζευγμένων ξῖ καὶ κάππα ἀνεστραμμένον — Ξ ⋊
διεζευγμένων διάτονος ἰῶτα καὶ λάμβδα πλάγιον — I ≺
νήτη διεζευγμένων ζῆτα καὶ πῖ πλάγιον — Z ⊏
τρίτη ὑπερβολαίων ει τετράγωνον καὶ πῖ ἀνεστραμμένον — E ⊔
ὑπερβολαίων διάτονος ω τετράγωνον ὕπτιον καὶ ζῆτα — ⅂⊔ Z
νήτη ὑπερβολαίων φῖ πλάγιον καὶ ἥτα ἀμελητικὸν καθειλκυσμένον — ⊕ ϟ

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3 ἔχον] ἔχοντα M. 6 λάβδα] ἄλφα M, pro V M quasi ∀. 20 notae ut 8 in tono lyd. 23 ξ min. 28 ε item. 30 ζ item. 32 καθειλκυσμένον add. Meib., om. libri.

Provenance and editable choices

The original PDF is 41700417 bytes. SHA-256: a442b3d4bbcf3ab6a8a0872f68ebc8a90e891985bf3fa40f4716767c02fb58e8. All five complete source images, three font files and both full font licenses were verified before embedding. The accompanying source manifest gives each retained identity. This file contains no scripts or automatic HTTP requests.

Complete source edition · Source and model decisions · Find Z over σov in the Seikilos inscription.

Selected diatonic Lydian sign pairs and four shared Lydian/Hypolydian pairs from Alypius, Jan 1895 pp368–370. Modern vector teaching signs, a newly composed practice line, chosen tuning and reference constraints, equal durations and synthetic sine tones. These are not a manuscript facsimile, a complete Greek notation decoder or a recovered ancient performance. External references require a connection; the embedded reading, images, sound and native downloads do not.